



DISASTER PREPAREDNESS and MANAGEMENT



Operations Manual

FOREWORD

This Disaster Preparedness and Management Operations Manual shall serve as a guide for the Department of Trade and Industry (DTI), particularly its National, Regional, and Provincial Offices in the planning and implementation of measures towards disaster preparedness.

While it provides step-by-step levels of action and decision-making processes adaptable to different situations, much is left to the sound judgment and discretion of DTI personnel who are exposed to handling different types of disasters in the field.

Nevertheless, this manual is intended to enhance uniformity, consistency, and direction in the areas of disaster preparedness and management falling within the mandate of the Department.

Bureau of Trade Regulation and Consumer Protection (BTRCP)

I. INTRODUCTION

Disasters are categorized into man-made and natural disasters. Natural disasters, such as floods, volcanic eruptions, earthquakes, tornadoes, landslides, and hurricanes, are brought about by changes in natural phenomenon. On the other hand, man-made disasters, such as technological, sociological, and transportation hazards; rebellion and war, among others, are caused by humans and they are often a result of negligence and error, among other factors.

All governmental and private entities responsible for large segments of the population should be prepared for these fateful natural and man-made disasters and put into force mitigation mechanisms and measures to reduce potential risk and loss of life and property. Government is mandated to prepare for disaster to reduce potential risks. This is strengthened by Republic Act (R.A.) 10121 known as the “Philippine Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Act of 2010.”

One of the mandatory remedial measures is to ensure the stable supply and prices of basic necessities and prime commodities, which fall under the DTI mandate. In line with this mandate, the DTI Disaster Preparedness and Management Operations Manual is prepared.

II. SCOPE

The DTI Disaster Preparedness and Management Operations Manual is anchored on the following laws, to wit:

A. R.A. No. 10121 or the Philippine Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Act of 2010

“Section 16: Declaration of State of Calamity. – The National Council shall recommend to the President of the Philippines the declaration of a cluster of barangays, municipalities, cities, provinces, and regions under a state of calamity, and the lifting thereof, based on the criteria set by the National Council. The President’s declaration may warrant international humanitarian assistance as deemed necessary.

The declaration and lifting of the state of calamity may also be issued by the local *sanggunian*, upon the recommendation of the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Council (NDRRMC), based on the results of the damage assessment and needs analysis.

“Section 17: Remedial Measures. – The declaration of a state of calamity shall make mandatory the immediate undertaking of the following remedial measures by the member-agencies concerned as defined in this Act:

- (a) Imposition of price ceiling on basic necessities and prime commodities by the President upon the recommendation of the implementing agency as provided for under R.A. No. 7581, otherwise known as the “Price Act,” or the National Price Coordinating Council.
- (b) Monitoring prevention and control by the Local Price Coordinating Council of overpricing/profitteering and hoarding of prime commodities, medicines and petroleum products;”

B. R.A. 7581 or the Price Act – An act providing protection to consumers by stabilizing the prices of basic necessities and prime commodities and by prescribing measures against undue price increase during emergency situation and like occasions.

“Section. 9. Allocation of a Buffer Fund to the Implementing Agency. - The implementing agency may procure, purchase, import, or stockpile any basic necessity or prime commodity, devise ways and means of distributing them for sale at reasonable prices in areas where there is supply shortage or a need to effect changes in its prevailing price. For any or all of these purposes, a buffer fund shall be allocated in the annual appropriations of the implementing agencies.

Section 10: Powers and responsibilities of Implementing Agencies

(8) He may, subject to existing laws, rules and regulations on bidding, enter into any agreement with owners or operators of warehouses

or storage houses or with owners, operators of franchise holders of vehicles or public utilities for the storage, transport, or distribution of any basic necessity or prime commodity;

(12) He may initiate summary proceedings to cause the seizure by the Government of basic necessities and prime commodities subject of a violation of this Act and order their sale to the public at reasonable prices whenever the nature of or the demand for such goods so requires.”

III. DEFINITION OF TERMS

Disaster – refers to a serious disruption of the functioning of a community or a society causing widespread human, material, economic, or environmental losses and impacts, which exceed the ability of the affected community or society to cope using its own resources. Disasters are often described as a result of the combination of: the exposure to a hazard, the conditions of vulnerability that are present, and insufficient capacity or measures to reduce or cope with the potential negative consequences. Disaster impacts may include, life loss, injury, disease, and other negative effects on human’s physical, mental, and social well-being, together with property damage, assets destruction, service loss, social and economic disruption, and environment degradation.

Preparedness – pre-disaster actions and measures being undertaken within the context of disaster risk reduction and management and are based on sound risk analysis as well as pre- disaster activities to avert or minimize life and property loss such as, but not limited to, community organizing, training, planning, equipping, stockpiling, hazard mapping, insuring of assets, and public information and education initiatives.

Response – any concerted effort by two or more agencies, public or private, to provide assistance or intervention during or immediately after a disaster to meet the life preservation and basic subsistence needs of those people affected and in the restoration of essential public activities and facilities.

Calamity-stricken areas – refer to areas that were affected by the calamities, emergencies, and like occurrences in any province.

Risk – the combination of the probability of an event and its negative consequences. Also, the probability of harmful consequences, or expected losses (deaths, injuries, properties, livelihoods, economic activity disruption, or environment damage) resulting from interactions between natural, human-induced hazards, and vulnerable conditions.

Buffer Fund – means a contingent fund in the budget of the implementing agency which shall not be used in its normal or regular operations but only for purposes provided for in this Act.

Basic Necessities—as defined in Paragraph 1, Section 3 of R.A. 7581 or the Price Act includes: rice; corn; bread; fresh, dried and canned fish and other marine products; fresh pork, beef, and poultry meal; fresh eggs; fresh and processed milk; fresh vegetables; root crops; coffee; sugar; cooking oil; salt; laundry soap; detergents; firewood; charcoal; candles; and drugs classified as essential by the Department of Health (DOH).

Prime Commodities – as defined in Paragraph 8, Section 3 of the Price Act includes fresh fruits; flour, dried; processed and canned pork, beef, and poultry meat; dairy products not falling under basic necessities; noodles; vinegar; onions; garlic; vinegar; *patis*; soy sauce; toilet soap; fertilizer; pesticides; herbicides; poultry; swine and cattle feeds; veterinary products for poultry, swine, and cattle; paper; nipa shingles; school supplies; *sawali*; cement; clinker; GI sheets; hollow blocks; plywood; plyboard; construction nails; batteries; electrical supplies; light bulbs; steel wires; and all drugs not classified as essential drugs by the DOH.

Price Ceiling – means the maximum price at which any basic necessity or prime commodity may be sold to the general public.

Prevailing Price – means the average price at which any basic necessity has been sold in a given area within a month from the occurrence of any of the conditions enumerated under Section 6 of the Price Act.

IV. DISASTER PREPAREDNESS

Considering the country's susceptibility to disasters and calamities, there is a need for DTI to ensure effectiveness in responding to its mandate under the Price Act. Hence, the Department shall put in place Provincial, Regional, and National Disaster Command Centers.

The roles and responsibilities of these Command Centers shall be as follows:

Provincial Disaster Command Center (PDCC) headed by the Provincial Director:

- ❑ Before any disaster/calamity strikes, assets and resources, facilities, tools, and equipment must be made available at all times. Hence, PDCC concerned, must have the following:
 - Generator sets
 - Transistors radios
 - Batteries and flashlights
 - First aid kits
 - Enforcement gadgets/devices and supplies (such as weighing scales, test weights, and other measuring equipment), and communication gadgets
 - Modes of transport including, if necessary, off-road vehicles such as motorcycles, mountain bikes, motor boats, or barges on lease basis
 - Other supplies deemed necessary (e.g. rain jackets, water-proof backpacks, water containers, etc.)
 - Very high frequency (VHF) radio asset and facilities on lease basis

- ❑ Identify and make arrangements with other provincial government agencies or private facilities/warehouses where basic necessities and prime commodities can be stored when needed as well as vehicles to bring in supply of goods on lease basis.
- ❑ Prepare and maintain a database to include:
 - List of retail outlets by city/municipality with inventory levels and the sources of basic necessities and construction materials supply
 - Information such as but not limited to name, email, contact numbers, and addresses of retail outlets and distributors in the province
 - Local/Provincial Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Councils
 - Areas prone to disaster and identification of critical roads and bridges that could affect the flow of goods to a city/town including alternative routes or sources of supply
- ❑ Monitor any news on impending calamity on TV/radio.
- ❑ Ensure the implementation of price freeze upon state of calamity declaration.
- ❑ Strengthen enforcement activities.
- ❑ Identify monitors/areas including monitors/teams to assist a province/region.

Regional Disaster Command Center (RDCC) headed by the Regional Director:

- ❑ Provide inter-provincial support as well as inter-regional support to ensure supply availability of basic necessities and prime commodities and construction materials.
- ❑ Maintain updated list of all retail outlets, distributors, and manufacturers within its region and nearby regions including all information as to contact details and addresses where supplies can be obtained.
- ❑ Facilitate action on issues raised through coordination with the Head Office and other Regional/National Agencies.

- ❑ Augment monitoring and enforcement teams in affected area/s.
- ❑ Ensure increased visibility in the market place and report Price Act violations.

National Disaster Command Center (NDCC) headed by the Consumer Welfare and Business Regulation Group (CWBRG) Undersecretary:

- ❑ Responsible for the overall management of activities in the national level to ensure availability of basic necessities and prime commodities before and after a calamity hits an area.
- ❑ Maintain a buffer fund for appropriate allocation to the provincial offices.
- ❑ Establish and formalize partnerships with but not limited to:
 - Manufacturers of basic necessities and prime commodities through a Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) as to provision of commodities at the instance a disaster strikes in an affected area and the information sharing on the conditions of retail outlets and/or distributors/depots regarding extent of damage (if any)
 - Government agencies with warehouses and storage facilities (e.g. National Food Authority [NFA] or duly accredited private sector) as to stockpiling of basic and prime commodities
 - Department of Transportation and Communications (DOTC) and all its attached agencies as to alternative government transport facilities and other utility vehicles to bring in the supply and communication line to each calamity-stricken area(s)
 - Department of Public Works and Highways (DPWH) as to program of work in available/alternative road network
 - Philippine Atmospheric, Geophysical and Astronomical Services Administration (PAGASA) or Philippine Institute of Volcanology and Seismology (PHIVOLCS) as to weather forecast, incoming weather bulletins and advisories.

- ❑ Maintain a database of the following:
 - Price Monitoring Reports
 - Directory/Mapping of Manufacturers/Distributors Warehouses/ Depots of basic necessities and prime commodities, including distributor/ flow of goods and inventory levels in plants and warehouses

V. DISASTER SCENARIO

The disaster scenarios shall be categorized as follows:

- ❑ **Category 1 – Extreme.** No stores open, no means of communication, no transportation, no electricity, no potable water.
- ❑ **Category 2 – Moderate.** Few stores open, limited supply, no electricity, no potable water, no regular transportation; and
- ❑ **Category 3 – Less Moderate.** Many stores open but limited supply, intermittent power supply, limited access of transportation and communication in some areas, potable water is available.

VI. DISASTER RESPONSE

The focus in the response phase is meeting the basic needs of the calamity-stricken consumers until the market situation has stabilized. If a province is incapable of responding to the disaster because the resources of said province were affected by the disaster, the nearest region and/or province will alternatively mobilize its resources to respond. Resources should be pre-identified by the province and/or the region.

The following measures shall be undertaken within 48 hours after a disaster/calamity hits the area/s:

CATEGORY I - EXTREME

Provincial	Regional	National
• Conduct its own assessment on the conditions of retail outlets, supermarkets, and wet markets and their inventory level • Coordinate with PDRRMC the extent of damage on infrastructure (roads, bridges) to identify critical areas within the province • Activate <i>Diskwento</i> Caravan within 48 hours after a disaster/calamity hits; • Identify sources of goods: retailers in the areas/wholesalers/depots in the vicinity	• Mobilize resources of nearest provinces (manpower and logistics) • Identify source of supplies of goods from nearest outlets and/or distributors and tap them for delivery of supplies • Contact private haulers of goods using other modes of transportation	• Coordinate with manufacturers/suppliers of basic necessities for a quick assessment of the area and possible logistical requirements to bring goods in • Coordinate with national government agencies to facilitate supplies delivery • Meet with NPCC (if necessary) to get overall update and provide directions to affected area/s

CATEGORY II - MODERATE

Provincial	Regional	National
- Assess market situation – inventory, price and supply, stores opened vs. stores closed, and assistance needed for the delivery of goods - Coordinate with the PDRPMC on the extent of infrastructure damage - Coordinate with suppliers of basic necessities - Determine the need for <i>Diskwento</i> Caravan within 48 hours after the calamity strikes	- Coordinate with local distributors and other major outlets in the region or nearby provinces for augmentation of supplies or - Identify and provide special mode of transportation thru alternate routes	- Keep track of reports and identify areas that need more support - Get reports from manufacturers and suppliers on the condition of their respective distributors and depots that may be affected and compare reports from DTI PDCC

CATEGORY III - LESS MODERATE

Provincial	Regional	National
- Assess market situation – inventory, price and supply, stores - Monitor prices and supply - Coordinate with the PDRPMC on the extent of damage on infrastructure - Prepare advisories and warnings and furnish Media	Work with major retail outlets and distributors in the region for supply augmentation through alternative routes.	Keep track of reports and identify area/s that need/s more support.

VII. DISASTER RECOVERY

During this stage, the Department's mandate and measures include:

- ❑ Price and supply monitoring, prevention, and control of overpricing/profitteering and hoarding of basic necessities and prime commodities.
- ❑ *Diskwento* Caravan – coordinate with local government units (LGUs) for the conduct of *Diskwento* Caravan for **logistical support** like venue and facilities such as tables, chairs, tents, sound system, etc.

PRICE MONITORING GUIDELINES IN TIMES OF CALAMITIES/ DISASTERS:

- ❑ Prices of basic necessities are automatically frozen at their prevailing prices or placed under automatic price control, unless otherwise declared by the President.
- ❑ The prevailing prices inputted in the web-based price monitoring report system (WPMRS) shall be the price freeze in the concerned area upon declaration of state of calamity.
- ❑ Daily price and supply monitoring of basic necessities and prime commodities shall be conducted immediately following the onset of a calamity or state of emergency.
- ❑ Frequency of monitoring may be reduced as soon as prices and supply situation have stabilized.
- ❑ Unless sooner lifted by the President, price control of basic necessities shall remain effective for 60 days.

PRODUCTS COVERED

- ☐ All brands and sizes of the following products based on the list of basic necessities and prime commodities under DTI's jurisdiction as provided by the Price Act:

Basic Necessities	Prime Commodities
• Canned fish and other marine products • Processed milk • Coffee • Laundry soap • Detergent • Candles • Bread • Salt	• Flour • Processed and canned pork • Processed and canned beef • Noodles • Vinegar, <i>patis</i>, soy sauce • Toilet soap • Paper • School supplies • Cement, clinker • G.I. sheets • Hollow blocks • Construction nails • Batteries • Electrical supplies • Light bulbs • Steel wires

SUBMISSION OF REPORTS DURING STATE OF EMERGENCY/CALAMITY

- ☐ Provincial Offices in areas declared under state of calamity shall monitor daily and email price and supply reports to btrcp_pmu@yahoo.com or fax to 890.4949 daily before 5:00p.m.
- ☐ The price/supply situations, road conditions, distribution problem, if any, and inventory levels whenever possible, shall be included in the daily report.
- ☐ After the initial reports, only commodities with price changes and supply problems, if any, shall be reported.
- ☐ Issues/problems encountered and action by Provincial Offices (POs)/Regional Offices (ROs) should be reported. Likewise, action/assistance, if needed from Head Office, should be included in the report.

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